

COMM 2025 - Persuasive Speech Topic Selection Report

Enter your answers in the fillable fields below. Your answers will help you develop the main points of your persuasive speech using Monroe's Motivated Sequence. Once you are finished, save and submit the file to the Persuasive Speech Topic Selection Report folder in Dropbox.

Need Step

The Need Step explains and proves that a problem exists. Note: You are not discussing the needs of the organization but rather the larger issue it addresses (e.g., homelessness, hunger, animal abuse, disease impact, pollution, or challenges faced by families with sick children).

1. Name of Selected Non-Profit Organization?

Second Harvest Food Bank of East Tennessee

2. What problem will you address in the Need Step?

Increasing food insecurity among families and children in our community

3. How does this problem affect your audience?

This problem affects my audience because it impacts our local schools, healthcare system, and economy. Even if we are not personally skipping meals, we live, work, and study alongside people who are, and that changes classroom focus, neighborhood safety, and overall community well being.

Satisfaction Step

The Satisfaction Step provides information about the non-profit organization and its programs.

1. What is your audience's current level of knowledge about this organization?

My audience probably has a general idea that food banks help people who need food, but they likely do not know how Second Harvest operates, who exactly they serve, or how much impact a single person's support can have.

2. What key information will you need to provide?

I will explain what Second Harvest does on a daily basis, the specific groups they serve, and the main programs they run. I will also share how they use donations and volunteers efficiently so the audience sees that even small contributions make a real difference.

Visualization Step

The Visualization Step illustrates the benefits of solving the problem or the consequences of inaction.

1. How will your audience benefit if this problem is solved?

If this problem is reduced through support for Second Harvest, more children will come to school focused on learning instead of hunger, families will have a safety net during emergencies, and our community will be stronger and more stable.

2. What negative effects might they experience if the problem persists?

If food insecurity continues to grow, more families will be forced to choose between groceries and other essentials, kids will struggle more in school, and local resources like schools, shelters, and hospitals will be placed under even more stress.

Action Step

Your goal is to persuade the audience to support the organization's efforts. Note: You are not asking them to solve the problem themselves, but rather to take specific actions in support of the organization.

1. What specific action(s) will you ask the audience to take?

I will ask my audience to bring at least one nonperishable food item to a collection next week and to follow Second Harvest online so they can stay informed and share information about future food drives and volunteer opportunities.

Addressing Objections

Anticipating and addressing potential objections can strengthen your persuasive appeal.

1. What objections might your audience have to taking this action?

My audience might think that their small donation will not matter, that they do not have enough money to help, or that they are too busy to volunteer. I will respond by explaining how even a single can of food or a single social media share can help the organization reach many more people.

2. Are there any limitations (e.g., time, money, physical ability) that could prevent them from supporting the organization?

Some audience members may not have extra money, transportation, or time. I will offer options that fit different limits, such as participating in the food collection if they can, sharing the nonprofit's posts online, or simply talking to friends and family about local food insecurity.